



Building Block #5

Cables provide a dramatic impact to knitting with very little effort. These twisted beauties are simply the result of knitting groups of stitches out of order. It can be our little secret how easy they are!

Cables are made by slipping a number of stitches from the left hand needle to a cable needle. The cable needle stitches are then held to either the front or the back of the work while working a number of stitches off the left hand needle. Lastly, the stitches held on the cable needle are worked to complete the cable.

Stitches held to the back of the work will create a cable that leans (crosses) to the right. Use the phrase, "I'll be RIGHT BACK" to help remember this principle. Stitches held to the front of the work will result in a cable that leans (crosses) to the left.

Cables draw in the fabric considerably, requiring additional stitches to maintain the established size. The Set up Row in this block incorporates many increases (kfb) to accommodate the cable design. At the end of the body's design, a decrease row is worked to restore the stitch count to its original number before working the top border of seed stitch.

Special Abbreviations

C6B Slip next 3 stitches onto cable needle and hold in **back** of work, knit next 3 stitches from left hand needle, then knit 3 stitches from cable needle.



Cables

C6F Slip next 3 stitches onto cable needle and hold in **front** of work, knit next 3 stitches from left hand needle, then knit 3 stitches from cable needle.

Bottom Border

Cast on 48 stitches using the Long Tail Cast On method.

Begin seed stitch as follows:

Row 1: *K1, p1; repeat from *.

Row 2: *P1, k1; repeat from *.

Work these 2 rows for a total of 6 rows.

Set up Row

This row is worked ONCE!

Work seed stitch over first 4 stitches.

Increase 14 stitches in Body as follows: *kfb, k2; repeat from * to last Body stitch, kfb.

Work seed stitch over last 4 stitches = 54 Body stitches for a total of 62 stitches.

Continue design beginning with **Row 2**.

Body

Maintain seed stitch over first and last 4 stitches of every row while working design over 54 center stitches.

Row 1: (P3, k6) twice, p3, k12, p3, (k6, p3) twice.

Row 2: (K3, p6) twice, k3, p12, k3, (p6, k3) twice.

Row 3: Same as Row 1.

Row 4: Same as Row 2.

Row 5: (P3, C6B) 3 times, (C6F, p3) 3 times.

Row 6: Same as Row 2.

Row 7: Same as Row 1.

Row 8: Same as Row 2.

Work above rows 7 times, ending last repeat after **Row 7**.

Decrease Row

Work seed stitch over first 4 stitches.

P2tog, *p2, p2tog; repeat from *.

Work seed stitch over last 4 stitches = 40 Body stitches for a total of 48 stitches.

Top Border

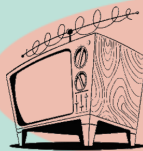
Work 5 rows of seed stitch as described in Bottom Border ending after Row 1.

Bind off in pattern.

Video Lessons

At knitpurlhunter.com under VIDEO TIPS

- Kfb (Knit Increase)
- Cables
- P2tog



Tips & Techniques

TIP: If using the hook shaped cable needle, keep it positioned to look a “J” throughout the cable process to prevent twisting. (See “Cable” video for demonstration.)

TIP: With the exception of creating the cables in Row 5, simply knit the knit stitches and purl the purl stitches in each row. (Now you can see why cable patterns are so popular!)